

Teenage Health — content for review

Every piece of new or materially changed copy created for the Teenage Health work, presented for word-by-word review. Nothing in this document is live in production yet.

Prepared 8 September 2026.

How to read this: Section 1 is the new Teenage Health page in full. Section 2 is the smaller pieces of supporting copy added elsewhere on the site, each with a note on where it appears. Section 3 collects the wording we deliberately kept cautious and would like you to confirm. Orange boxes flag wording for your medical/legal review.

1. Teenage Health — hub page

Page name	Teenage Health
Final URL	https://dramandahenderson.com.au/teenage-health
Primary intent	People (teenagers and parents) deciding whether to see a GP about a teenage health concern, and whether Dr Henderson is a suitable GP — "GP for teenagers / teenage health, Maroubra & Sydney's Eastern Suburbs".
Meta title	Teenage & Adolescent Health GP in Maroubra Dr Amanda Henderson
Meta description	Down-to-earth GP care for teenagers in Maroubra and Sydney's Eastern Suburbs: periods, skin, mood and anxiety, sleep and everyday health, with room to talk privately.
H1	Teenage Health

HEADING OUTLINE

- H1 — Teenage Health
- H2 — In brief
- H2 — What I can help a teenager with (*H3s: Growing up and puberty; Periods and reproductive health; Skin, especially acne; Mood, anxiety and stress; Sleep, energy and tiredness; Everyday health and prevention*)
- H2 — Reasons it might be worth booking
- H2 — What a first visit is like
- H2 — What stays between the doctor and the patient (*eyebrow: Privacy*)
- H2 — A note for parents
- H2 — Common questions
- H2 — Related reading
- H2 — Sources & further reading
- H2 — Book for your teenager, or for yourself (*closing booking band*)

EYEBROW

Care for teenagers & their families

OPENING / INTRO

Teenagers do better with a GP who takes them seriously and gives them room to speak for themselves. I look after young people through the in-between years — for period problems and skin, low mood and anxiety, tiredness, and the ordinary business of staying well — and I'm glad to see them with a parent, on their own, or a bit of both.

IN BRIEF (CITEABLE SUMMARY)

- Dr Amanda Henderson is a family GP (FRACGP) in Maroubra who cares for teenagers as part of general practice.
- Common reasons to visit include periods, acne, low mood or anxiety, ongoing tiredness, and everyday health questions.
- Part of a consultation can happen privately between the teenager and doctor — a normal part of adolescent care.
- A GP can assess a concern, start treatment, and arrange a referral if a specialist or another service is needed.

WHAT I CAN HELP A TEENAGER WITH (CARDS)

Growing up and puberty. Questions about development, periods starting, height, weight or whether what's happening is normal. Often the reassurance is the treatment, and knowing what to expect makes the rest easier.

Periods and reproductive health. Painful, heavy or irregular periods, period-related mood changes, and questions about contraception or sexual health as they become relevant. Most of this is straightforward to sort in general practice.

Skin, especially acne. Acne is common and very treatable, and starting sooner helps prevent scarring and the knock to confidence. There is far more available than the products on the pharmacy shelf.

Mood, anxiety and stress. Low mood, worry and panic, school and social pressure, and the flat, worn-out feeling that often comes with them. A GP is a sensible — and confidential — first stop.

Sleep, energy and tiredness. Teenagers are often genuinely exhausted. Sometimes it is sleep and screens, sometimes low iron or thyroid, occasionally mood. It is worth checking rather than guessing.

Everyday health and prevention. Coughs, headaches, gut troubles, sports injuries, vaccinations and the occasional worrying symptom — the same everyday reasons any of us see a GP.

PARAGRAPH BENEATH THE CARDS (WITH INTERNAL LINKS)

Some of this overlaps with other parts of the practice: periods and contraception sit within women's health, and low mood, anxiety and sleep within general GP care. A teenager doesn't need to know which box a problem belongs in — that's my job.

Underlined phrases are internal links: "women's health" → /womens-health, "general GP care" → /general-gp-care.

REASONS IT MIGHT BE WORTH BOOKING (LIST)

- Periods are painful, heavy, irregular or getting in the way of school
- Acne is bothering you and the pharmacy products aren't cutting it
- You've felt low, anxious or not yourself for more than a couple of weeks
- You're tired all the time and can't work out why

- There's a question about your body you'd rather ask a doctor than the internet
- A parent has noticed a change and you'd both like it looked at

WHAT A FIRST VISIT IS LIKE

A first visit is mostly conversation. I'll ask what's brought you in and how it's affecting your days, examine you if it's useful, and explain plainly what I think is going on and what the choices are. Some things are settled in one visit; others are worth trying something and reviewing. A parent is welcome for all of it, part of it, or none of it — whatever suits.

Seeing a doctor on your own for the first time can feel like a big step. In practice it's mostly a conversation. You don't need the medical words for what's going on, and the things that feel awkward to say out loud are usually the ones worth saying.

For parents, this is often the age where your job shifts from speaking for your child to helping them speak for themselves. Both of you are welcome, and there's no single right way to do it.

PRIVACY CALLOUT — "WHAT STAYS BETWEEN THE DOCTOR AND THE PATIENT"

As young people get older they take on more of their own healthcare, and part of a consultation may happen one-to-one between the teenager and me. That's a routine part of adolescent care — a chance to ask the question they didn't want to ask in front of anyone — not a way of leaving parents out.

In general, what a young person tells their doctor is kept private, in much the same way it is for an adult. There are limits, and I'm honest about them: if I'm seriously worried about someone's safety — their own or someone else's — I may need to involve a parent or another service. If that happens, I'll talk it through first wherever I can.

Whether a young person can make a particular decision about their own care depends on how well they understand what's involved, rather than on reaching a set age. Most of the time it's worked out together, with a parent still part of the picture.

Flag for your review: this whole privacy section, and the two related FAQs below ("Is what my teenager tells the doctor kept private?" and "At what age can a teenager see a GP on their own?"). The wording deliberately avoids a fixed consent age and avoids absolute confidentiality promises (reflecting the "mature minor" approach in NSW/Australia and the safety-based limits to confidentiality). Please confirm it matches how you practise and is worded to your comfort.

A NOTE FOR PARENTS

Bringing your teenager to a GP who takes them seriously — and gives them a little room — is one of the more useful things you can do for their long-term health. It's how young people learn that looking after themselves is normal and that a doctor is a safe person to talk to.

You're not being sidelined. For most visits you'll be there for the bulk of it, and you're always welcome to raise what's worrying you.

Care is provided by [Dr Amanda Henderson](#), a family GP (FRACGP) in Maroubra, who sees teenagers and families from across Sydney's Eastern Suburbs. (*"Dr Amanda Henderson..." links to /about.*)

COMMON QUESTIONS (FAQS)

What can a GP actually help a teenager with?

A great deal — periods and reproductive health, acne and other skin problems, low mood and anxiety, sleep and constant tiredness, headaches and gut troubles, vaccinations, sports injuries, and any new symptom that's worrying you. A GP can assess it, start treatment, and arrange tests or a referral when that's the right step.

Can my teenager see the GP without me in the room?

Yes, if that's what they'd like. Many visits run with a parent there for part of the appointment and the young person seen on their own for another part. Seeing a teenager by themselves for a few minutes is a normal piece of adolescent care — it helps them practise speaking up about their own health, and it doesn't mean anything is wrong.

Is what my teenager tells the doctor kept private?

Generally yes — a young person's privacy is respected in much the same way as an adult's. There are limits: if I'm seriously concerned about their safety, or someone else's, I may need to involve a parent or another service. If that ever comes up, I'll be upfront about it rather than going behind anyone's back.

At what age can a teenager see a GP on their own?

There isn't a single birthday where everything changes over. Whether a young person can make their own decisions about care depends on how well they understand what's involved, and that develops at different times for different people. In practice we work it out together, and a parent is usually still part of the picture.

Does a parent have to come to the appointment?

For a first visit, anything complicated, or a younger teenager, it helps to have a parent there. An older teenager can also book and come on their own. Either way, they'll be listened to and taken seriously.

What happens at the first appointment?

Mostly talking. I'll ask what's going on and how it's affecting you, examine you only if it's relevant, explain what I think and lay out the options, and we'll agree the next step together. Nothing happens without it being explained first.

When would a GP involve another doctor or service?

General practice handles most teenage health concerns from start to finish. When something calls for a paediatrician, a psychologist, a gynaecologist or another specialist, I'll say so, explain why, and help arrange it — you won't be left to sort it out alone.

RELATED READING (LINKS TO EXISTING ARTICLES)

- Acne treatment for teens and adults: when to see a GP
- Understanding what causes heavy periods
- Contraception options in Australia: how a GP can help you choose
- Sexual health, vaginal symptoms and STI testing: a GP visit should feel safe
- Lifestyle medicine: weight, sleep, alcohol, smoking and wellbeing

SOURCES & FURTHER READING (EXTERNAL LINKS)

- headspace — Australian mental health support for young people aged 12–25
- Kids Helpline — free, confidential 24/7 phone and online counselling for ages 5–25
- ReachOut — youth wellbeing information, with a dedicated section for parents
- Healthdirect — Puberty
- Healthdirect — Acne

Intro line above these links: "Trusted Australian services for young people and parents. If something is urgent or you just need to talk, these are good places to start."

CALL TO ACTION (CLOSING BAND)

Book for your teenager, or for yourself. Appointments can be made online through HotDoc, or call the practice. A young person is welcome to book on their own, or with a parent.

Buttons throughout the page: "Book an appointment" (HotDoc) and "Call (02) 9311 9311". No new appointment types, hours, fees or availability are claimed.

INTERNAL LINKS ON THIS PAGE

- "women's health" → /womens-health
- "general GP care" → /general-gp-care
- "Dr Amanda Henderson, a family GP (FRACGP) in Maroubra" → /about
- Related-reading article titles → the five /articles/... pages listed above
- "Explore also" chips → /womens-health, /general-gp-care, /childrens-health

2. Supporting copy added elsewhere on the site

Small pieces of new copy that surface Teenage Health across the site. Each notes where it appears.

Homepage — "How I Can Help" Card

Eyebrow: Care for teenagers & their families **Title:** Teenage Health

Summary: Down-to-earth GP care for teenagers — periods, skin, mood and anxiety, sleep and everyday health — with room to talk privately when it helps.

Appears as a fifth card in the "A GP for the things that matter to you" grid on the homepage, alongside the four existing areas.

About Page — Areas of Clinical Interest

"Teenage Health" is added as a fifth item in the "Areas of clinical interest" list, linking to /teenage-health. No other About copy changed.

Navigation (Header & Footer)

"Teenage Health" added to the primary navigation (which also drives the footer "Explore" list), between "General GP Care" and "Articles". *On large screens the full menu now appears from 1280px; between 1024–1279px the existing menu button is used, so eight items never crowd the header. All links remain in the page for search engines.*

Cross-links from existing pages ("Explore also")

A "Teenage Health" chip is added to the "Explore also" row at the foot of three existing pages, where it is genuinely relevant: **Women's Health**, **Children's Health** and **General GP Care**. No other copy on those pages changed.

LLMS.TXT & Structured Data (No visible copy)

Teenage Health is listed automatically in llms.txt (the AI-discovery file) with its title and summary. In the site's structured data it is added to the doctor's knowsAbout (Adolescent health, Teenage health, Puberty and development, Adolescent mental health, Acne, Menstrual health, Adolescent immunisation) and to availableService as "Teenage Health". These are machine-readable only.

3. Wording kept deliberately cautious — for your confirmation

1. Confidentiality & privacy. The "What stays between the doctor and the patient" section and the two privacy FAQs. Written to reflect that (a) part of an adolescent consult may occur one-to-one, (b) a young person's confidentiality is generally respected but has safety-based limits, and (c) capacity to consent depends on understanding rather than a fixed age (the "mature minor" approach). No specific age is stated. Please confirm the wording.

2. "Normal part of adolescent care" framing. The page describes seeing a teenager alone for part of a visit as routine. This is standard practice, but flagged so you can confirm it reflects how you run appointments.

3. Nothing operational was invented. No teen-specific clinic, longer appointments, fees, bulk billing, same-day or specific availability is claimed. If you want any of those mentioned, they can be added once confirmed.

Not flagged, for the record: no medical facts were invented, no specialist qualifications implied, and clinical topics are framed as areas a GP can assess, begin managing, and refer on where appropriate. External medical detail is linked to headspace, Kids Helpline, ReachOut and Healthdirect rather than reproduced.